



NEON BIOREPOSITORY Sample Use Agreement

Title:

Requestor

Name:

Institution:

Address:

Phone:

Email:

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

Failure to comply with any of the terms of this agreement may result in refusal to fulfill any future requests for NEON Biorepository samples from members of this research team.

Terms of use

Samples may only be used for the research purposes described in the “Description of Sample Use” below. Significant changes to the scope, methods, or objectives of the approved research must be communicated to and approved by the NEON Biorepository prior to implementation.

Researchers must maintain timely communication with the NEON Biorepository regarding the status, condition, and use of loaned samples, as well as the progress of the approved research. Researchers shall notify the NEON Biorepository of all authored/co-authored publications in which physical samples and/or sample data are used and provide electronic copies of those publications. Failure to maintain communication may affect eligibility for future sample requests.

All loaned or unused materials must be returned to the NEON Biorepository within the approved loan period (see the “Additional Terms and Conditions”). Extensions may be granted in writing prior to the due date, if no other requests for the samples exist.

In some cases, material remaining after consumptive or destructive use (e.g., DNA extracts or individuals removed from bulk samples) must also be returned for archival. Materials, labeling, and archival requirements for these materials are outlined in the “Additional Terms and Conditions” section below. Unless otherwise arranged in writing, users will be required to cover sample return costs.

The researcher’s institution is responsible for proper handling, storage, and use of all samples while in their possession and for ensuring compliance with this Sample Use Agreement, including maintaining

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appropriate storage conditions and preventing loss or contamination. The NEON Biorepository must be notified promptly if samples are lost, damaged, or compromised while in the researcher's possession.

Citations

Samples: NEON samples and specimens involved in published research must be listed in either the main text or supplemental information of any relevant publication. The occurrenceID or full IGSN ID should be used to refer to samples (e.g., <https://doi.org/10.58052/NEON0D0YI>, [igsn:10.58052/NEON0D0YI](https://doi.org/10.58052/NEON0D0YI) or [igsn:NEON0D0YI](https://doi.org/10.58052/NEON0D0YI)) in manuscript text as well as in any data repositories, such as GenBank. In cases where IGSN ID use is already clearly denoted, the preceding igsn: tag may be excluded. Where possible, all representations of IGSN IDs should be hyperlinked with the IGSN ID's complete DOI link. Authors are encouraged to follow established conventions for formatting and displaying IGSN IDs as described by [IGSN e.V.](#) and [DataCite](#) guidelines. A complete list of samples provided will be attached to this Sample Use Agreement to support accurate physical sample citations.

Data: Records in the NEON Biorepository Sample Portal are periodically updated based on ingestion of the most up-to-date NEON data and are, in many cases, supplemented with value-added data obtained from further analysis. Because these records are updated on a rolling basis and are not tied to a specific NEON data release, NEON Biorepository sample data should be considered subject to change and treated as provisional. Citations of these data should therefore follow NEON guidance for provisional data, applied to the relevant Biorepository sample types. To support data citation, this Sample Use Agreement will include a unique download link (See "Additional Terms and Agreements") that will allow users to retrieve the most current associated data for their requested samples provided through the NEON Biorepository Sample Portal.

For each sample type used:

Example for sample data which have been saved to an external repository and assigned a DOI:
NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository. NEON Biorepository Mammal Collection (Ear Tissue). Data accessed from <https://biorepo.neonscience.org/portal/collections/misc/neoncollprofiles.php?collid=25> on January 25, 2021. Data archived at [your DOI].

Example for sample data which have not been saved to an external repository (not recommended):
NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository. NEON Biorepository Mammal Collection (Ear Tissue). Data accessed from <https://biorepo.neonscience.org/portal/collections/misc/neoncollprofiles.php?collid=25> on January 25, 2021.

If additional data are obtained directly from the NEON Data Portal (e.g., via download, API access, or programmatic tools), the relevant NEON Data Product(s) must also be cited in accordance with NEON data citation guidance, including the appropriate release DOI or provisional data citation.

Images: Unless stated otherwise, images are made available under the Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike (CC BY-SA) license. Users are allowed to copy, transmit, reuse, and/or adapt content, as long as attribution regarding the source of the content is made. If the content is altered, transformed, or enhanced, it may be re-distributed only under the same or similar license by which it was acquired.

Use the following template to cite images accessed via the NEON Biorepository Data Portal:

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Template: [Creator (if known)]. NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository. Accessed via NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository Sample Portal [DATE ACCESSED]. [IMAGE TITLE or FILENAME]. [IMAGE TYPE (e.g., Photograph)]. [URL]

Example: Steger, L., NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository. Accessed via NEON (National Ecological Observatory Network) Biorepository Sample Portal [2025-09-23] . B00000021553_1611185823_lg. Photograph.
https://biorepo.neonscience.org/imglib/neon/NEON_MAMC-VSS/00000/B00000021553_1611185823_lg.jp

Acknowledgement: Any publications involving use of NEON samples and specimens should include the following acknowledgment:

"The National Ecological Observatory Network is a program sponsored by the U.S. National Science Foundation and operated under cooperative agreement by Battelle. This material uses specimens and/or samples collected as part of the NEON Program and provided by the NEON Biorepository at Arizona State University."

If the sampling scheme, design, or operations of the NEON Biorepository is integral to facilitating a publication, we encourage citation of the following publication:

Thibault KM, Laney CM, Yule KM, Franz NM, Mabee PM. (2023). The US National Ecological Observatory Network and the Global Biodiversity Framework: National research infrastructure with a global reach. *Journal of Ecology and Environment*. 47:21.
<https://doi.org/10.5141/jee.23.076>

Derived data and media

Researchers using NEON Biorepository samples must provide all resulting sample-associated data to NEON for publication via the NEON Sample Portal for public use within 2 years of sample receipt or upon publication, whichever comes first. Special exceptions regarding data embargos, sensitive data, or extensions may be arranged in writing. This data includes, but is not limited to, species determinations, (raw and derived specimen-level) images and other media files, and links to externally-hosted genetic and genomic sequence data. Instructions for providing these data to the NEON Biorepository will be outlined in this Sample Use Agreement (See "Additional Terms and Conditions"). Future users of requestor-derived data and images will be encouraged to cite the original publications, which will be linked in associated sample records within the NEON Sample Portal. The NEON Biorepository is not responsible for use of derived data and media by external parties that violates our published citation and attribution guidelines.

Receiving and Handling Samples

Within one week of receiving samples, researchers shall inspect sample shipments and contact the NEON Biorepository if any samples are missing, have been damaged during shipping, or have been received in error. Researchers must return a signed copy of the [Sample Receipt Confirmation](#) to the NEON Biorepository immediately after inspection.

All labels, tags, and accompanying data are to be kept in association with samples. Loaned material should be stored in secure cabinetry in a secure, climate-controlled facility for the duration of the loan. Loaned fluid-preserved specimens should be maintained in the proper fluid and kept moist in that fluid during examination (never transferred to water, even briefly). Loaned sample materials requiring

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controlled temperature storage must be handled appropriately throughout the duration of the loan period and return shipment to maintain the necessary cold chain.

Samples should not be transferred to another institution without approval in writing from the NEON Biorepository.

Researchers shall not subject loaned material to any mechanical or chemical treatments or other destructive, consumptive or invasive use without prior approval.

All loaned samples and other agreed upon material being returned to the NEON Biorepository shall be shipped via UPS, FedEx, DHL, USPS priority mail or other such high-quality carriers with tracking capability. Loan materials should be carefully packed in a manner consistent with archiving needs, adhering to all applicable IATA/DOT Dangerous Goods regulations. Loan recipients are expected to have or acquire any needed permits to receive and ship samples – e.g., USDA-APHIS permits for dry soil samples.

Additional requirements may apply to samples collected at NEON sites located within National Park Service lands.

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DESCRIPTION OF SAMPLE USE:**Requestor
initials:**
_____**ADDITIONAL TERMS AND CONDITIONS:***Loan, data, and/or multimedia return due dates and special instructions:***Requestor
initials:**
_____*Link to the most current associated sample data for citation:***Requestor
initials:**
_____*Additional attribution and citation requirements:***Requestor
initials:**
_____*Archival of derived materials:***Requestor
initials:**
_____*Other special terms and agreements:***Requestor
initials:**

By signing this agreement and accessing NEON Biorepository samples and/or data, I agree to be bound by the NEON Sample Use Policy and all terms and conditions listed above. I acknowledge that failure to adhere to the terms and conditions of this agreement could result in revocation of current and future privileges provided by the NEON Biorepository:

Signature_____
Printed Name_____
Date_____
Signature_____
Printed Name_____
Date

This agreement is hereby authorized and approved by the following representative of the NEON Biorepository:

Signature_____
Printed Name_____
Date